Department of Computer Applications

24MCE11 - Design Thinking

Worksheets

Academic Year : 2025-26 **Batch : 2025-27**

SEM : II (Even) **Year : I MCA A&B**

Interview Notes Template

Interview 1:

Project Title: Newsletter Template Generator

Group Name: Team 8

Interview Date: 18.2.2026

Interviewer Name: Kavinesh S R

Interviewee Role (Student/Faculty/etc.): Faculty

Questions Asked:

1. What is the main objective of this project?
2. Why is a newsletter important for a department?
3. What should be the overall purpose of the newsletter system?
4. What is the purpose of developing a newsletter template generator?

Raw Responses:

Q1 Response:

The objective of the project is to design a structured newsletter template system for the department.

Q2 Response:

The newsletter should collect and present information related to the department.

Q3 Response:

It should help organize department updates and information in a proper format.

Q4 Response:

It should help organize department information properly and make documentation easier.

Key Insights Identified:

1. The main objective of the project is to develop a Newsletter Template Generator.
2. The newsletter is important for collecting and presenting department information.
3. The system should help organize updates in a structured and proper format.
4. The generator should simplify documentation and improve efficiency.
5. A standardized format will enhance clarity and consistency in presentation.

Interview 2:

Project Title: Newsletter Template Generator

Group Name: Team 8

Interview Date: 20.2.2026

Interviewer Name: Kavinesh S R

Interviewee Role (Student/Faculty/etc.): Faculty

Questions Asked:

1. How should the department newsletter be designed in terms of format and style? Should it resemble a newspaper, magazine, or something different?
2. What sections or elements should be included at the beginning of the department newsletter?
3. Whose messages or dedicated sections should be included in the newsletter?
4. What type of content should be included in the main news section of the newsletter?
5. What features would make a newsletter template generator more useful for the department?

Raw Responses:

Q1 Response:

This should not be like a newspaper or magazine. It should be a structured design containing all news collected from our department.

Q2 Response:

The newsletter should start with the Vision, Mission, and College Logo followed by the Department Outcomes.Q3 Response:

There should be various persons desk like as HOD desk, Faculty Desk, Coordinators Desk and Student desk.

Q4 Response:

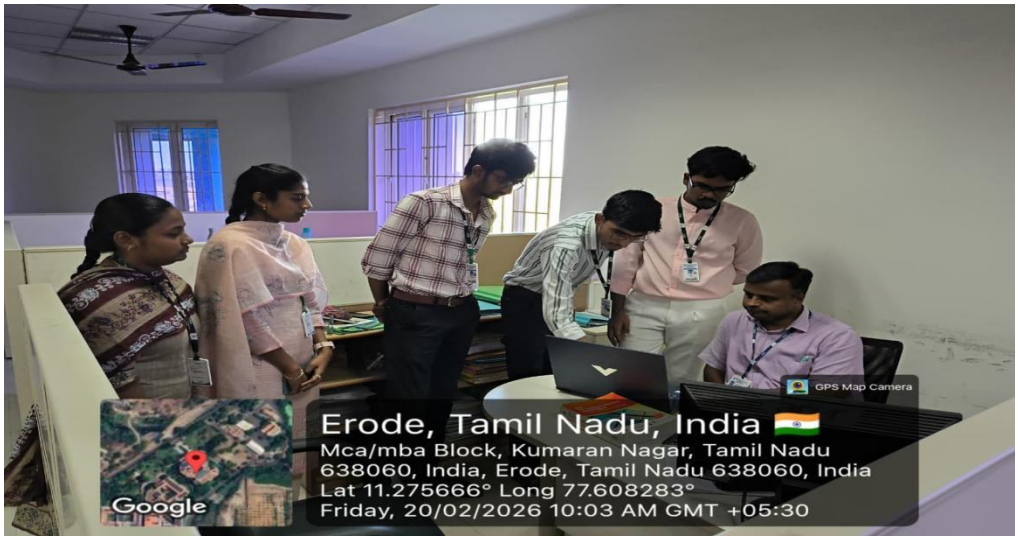
After this, the news section should include both recent and upcoming activities.

Q5 Response:

The system should support adding sections easily, allow image uploads, maintain proper alignment, and enable rearranging sections without affecting the design.

Key Insights Identified:

- The newsletter should follow a structured academic design instead of a newspaper or magazine format.
- The beginning of the newsletter must include Vision, Mission, College Logo, and Department Outcomes.
- Dedicated sections such as HOD Desk, Faculty Desk, Coordinator Desk, and Student Desk are necessary.
- The newsletter should contain both recent activities and upcoming events.
- Manual preparation of the newsletter takes more time and causes formatting inconsistencies.
- A structured template system is needed to maintain uniform design.
- The system should allow easy content entry and automatic formatting.
- The layout should be flexible enough to edit or rearrange sections without affecting the overall design.



Empathy Map Sheet

Problem: Manual preparation of the department newsletter is time-consuming and lacks consistent structure.

Target User: Department Faculty and Student Coordinators

SAYS:

(What does the user say openly?)

- The newsletter should not look like a newspaper or magazine.
- Vision and Mission must be included at the beginning.
- There should be HOD, Faculty, Coordinator, and Student desk sections.
- It must include recent and upcoming department activities.
- A proper structured template would make the work easier.

THINKS:

(What are they thinking but not saying?)

- The newsletter should represent the department professionally.
- The design must be consistent and organized.
- Formatting takes too much time.
- A standard format would reduce effort.

DOES:

(What actions do they take?)

- Collects content manually from faculty and students.
- Arranges sections in Word or PPT.
- Adjusts alignment, spacing, and formatting repeatedly.
- Spends time correcting layout issues.

FEELS:

(What emotions are involved?)

- Feels responsible for maintaining professional presentation.
- Wants to improve efficiency in preparation.
- Concerned about maintaining professional appearance.
- Wants a simpler and faster solution.

SEES:

(What environment influences them?)

- Academic newsletters with structured layouts.
- Opportunities to improve design consistency.
- Digital tools that can simplify documentation.

HEARS:

(What do others tell them?)

- Make it more professional.
- Include all department details properly.
- Improve the structure and presentation.

Pain Points Identified:

- Lack of fixed structure
- Time-consuming formatting
- Repetitive manual work
- Difficulty in managing multiple sections

Opportunity Identified:

There is an opportunity to develop a structured newsletter template generator that automates formatting, maintains consistency, reduces manual effort, and improves professional presentation.

STEEP Analysis Worksheet

Project: Newsletter Template Generator

Factor	Observations	Impact on Project
Social	Departments require professional and structured academic documentation.	The system must enhance communication and reflect departmental identity clearly.
Technological	Digital tools and automation systems are widely available for documentation.	Automation can ensure consistent layout and reduce manual formatting effort.
Economic	Manual preparation consumes time and printing increases costs.	A digital generator can reduce preparation time and support cost-effective distribution.
Environmental	Institutions are encouraging reduced paper usage and digital communication.	Promoting digital newsletters supports eco-friendly practices.
Political / Policy	Academic institutions follow specific documentation standards and formats.	The system must align with institutional guidelines and structured presentation norms.

Most Critical STEEP Factor:

Technological – because the success of the project depends on digital automation and structured layout generation.

Stakeholder Analysis Sheet

Project: Newsletter Template Generator

Stakeholder	Role	Influence (Low/Med/High)	Interest (Low/Med/High)	Engagement Strategy
HOD	Approves final newsletter	High	High	Manage Closely
Faculty Members	Provide content and guidance	Medium	High	Keep Informed
Student Editors	Compile and organize content	High	High	Manage Closely
Students	Contribute articles and news	Medium	Medium	Keep Informed
Management	Oversees institutional branding	High	Medium	Keep Satisfied

Stakeholder Category (Power–Interest):

Manage Closely: HOD, Student Editors

Keep Satisfied: Management

Keep Informed: Faculty Members, Students

Monitor: External Readers

Observation Notes Template

Project: Newsletter Template Generator

Location Observed: MCA Department

Date: 21.2.2026

What Did You Observe?

The department newsletter is prepared by collecting content from multiple contributors such as faculty and students. The sections are arranged manually, and formatting is adjusted carefully to maintain structure. Significant effort is taken to ensure alignment, consistency, and proper sequencing of sections like Vision, Mission, Articles, Placements, and Research details. The process requires coordination among team members and careful review before final submission.

Frequency of Issue:

☐ Rare

☐ Sometimes

✓ Often

☐ Very Frequent

Who Was Involved?

1. Faculty coordinators
2. Student editorial team members

Root Cause:

The absence of a structured and automated template system requires manual formatting and arrangement of content.

Possible Opportunity:

Developing a newsletter template generator can standardize the structure, automate formatting, reduce preparation time, and improve overall presentation quality.

Final HMW Statements:

1. How might we improve the process of department newsletter creation so that content can be organized easily while maintaining a consistent and professional academic format?
2. How might we design a structured and automated newsletter template system that reduces manual effort while improving presentation quality?